



(Don't Write anything in this Area)

- 6.b) To what extent has anthropology's colonial legacy shaped the formation and evolution of its conceptual frameworks, theoretical constructs, and epistemological paradigms? (15 marks)

Anthropology is perhaps colonial handmaiden with Anthropological beginning in India traced to 'Asiatic Society of Bengal (1784)

Anthropology as per Vidyarthi's 4 fold classification in its formative stage in India is owed to colonialist ethnography
 a) Shakespeare work in Cochin Bator

Besides, the very need for administering India better, led to colonial ethnography and survey making

Colonial legacy on conceptual framework

① Ideas of evolutionism → data aggregated from researchers, missionaries etc lead to evolutionary schemata
 → Savagery - Barbarism - Civilisation
 (LH Morgan)

- Concept of "White man's burden"
ethnic supremacy
 ↳ early colonialists wanted to civilize the modern world
- Archaeological Survey of India
 under aegis of [R.E.M. Wheeler]
 contributed to Indus valley Civilization re-discovery
 as well as commissioning monument conservation
 (eg) Hampi - Vijaynagara
- Survey [Census survey with Caste enumeration] as a concept to administer masses
- Wholly Extended Area / Partially Extended Area as precursor for Scheduled Area for tribal conservation.

Theoretical constructs of Anthropo

- Cultural relativism → emboldened by exposure to diverse Indian beliefs
- (eg) Margaret Harniss citing cow in India for cultural materialism

- Diffusionism : Using the civilisational approach of Redfield etc to formulate the Rural-urban continuum present studies in India

Epistemological paradigms

Anthropologists, aided by colonialists, attempt to discover what drives India's mentality.

In order to govern, they commissioned a Dept of Anthropology (Bombay) in 1920 while also conferring S.C. Roy & L.

Anantharamayan significant academic positions to consult on tribal issues.